

Geography

Middletown High School | Grade 12, Fall Semester 2026

Teacher: Mr. S. Ibarra
Room: 118
Email: sibarra@middletownhigh.edu

Course Description

Physical and human geography, from plate tectonics to cities and resources, including a river fieldwork study with data collected by the class.

Course Units

Weeks 1 to 3	Unit 1: Plate Tectonics and Hazards Constructive (divergent), destructive (convergent) and conservative (transform) boundaries. Earthquakes occur at all three. Volcanoes occur mainly at constructive and destructive boundaries.
Weeks 4 to 6	Unit 2: Weather and Climate Air pressure, fronts, the global circulation and the difference between weather and climate.
Weeks 7 to 10	Unit 3: Rivers and Coasts Erosion by hydraulic action, abrasion, attrition and solution, then transport and deposition. Landforms include waterfalls, meanders, ox bow lakes and floodplains.
Weeks 11 to 13	Unit 4: Urbanization City growth, land use models, informal settlements and sustainable urban planning.
Weeks 14 to 16	Unit 5: Resource Management Water, energy and food security, and the trade offs between them.

Key Dates This Semester

Oct 1	Map Skills Test
Oct 26	Mid-Term Exam, covers Units 1 to 2
Nov 10	River Fieldwork Write-up due
Dec 17	Final Exam

School wide dates

Sep 8	First day of classes
Oct 19 to Oct 23	Mid-term examination week
Nov 6	Parent teacher conferences
Nov 25 to Nov 27	Thanksgiving break, no classes
Dec 14 to Dec 18	Final examination week

Materials

Atlas (provided), ruler, colored pencils, waterproof jacket and boots for fieldwork day.

Grading Policy

20 percent	Fieldwork and write-up
15 percent	Homework
15 percent	Map and skills tests
30 percent	Unit tests
20 percent	Final exam

A = 90 to 100 percent, B = 80 to 89, C = 70 to 79, D = 60 to 69, F = 59 and below.

Late and Make-Up Work

Work handed in late without an excused absence receives a maximum of 50 percent credit. With an excused absence, work is due within one week of returning. It is the student's responsibility to ask what was missed. Make-up tests are held on Thursdays after school and must be booked at least one day ahead.

Academic Honesty

All work submitted must be your own. Copying another student's work, or submitting text or code generated by someone or something else as your own, is treated as academic dishonesty and results in a zero for that assignment and a call home.

Extra Help

Extra help is available Tuesdays and Thursdays, 3:15 to 4:00 pm, in the room listed above.